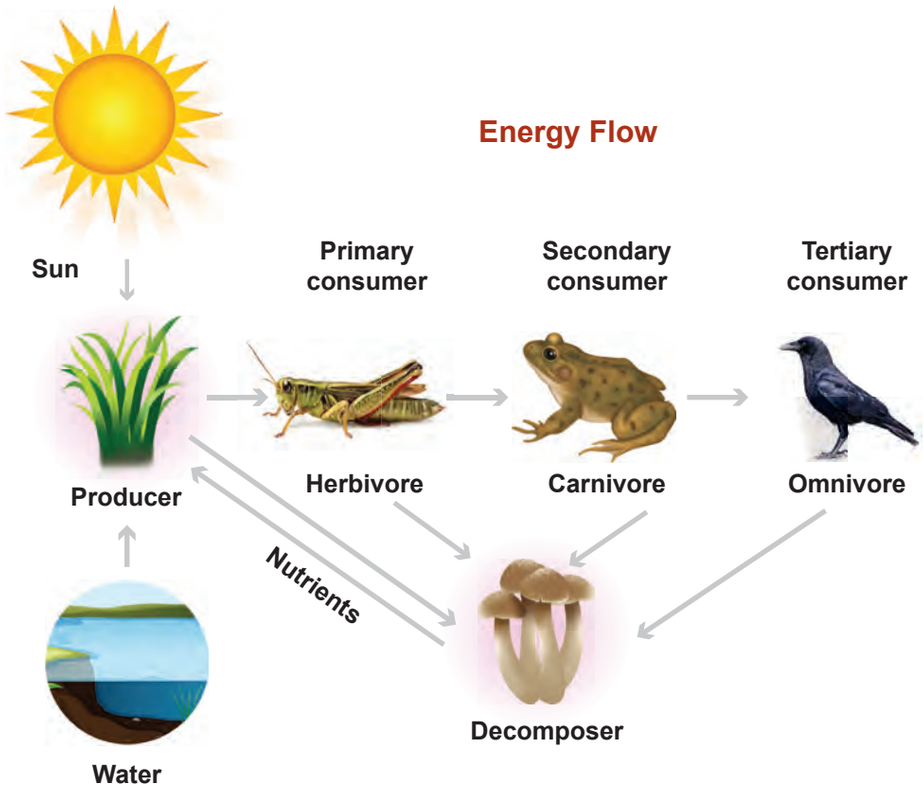


The micro organism degrade the excreta and the dead bodies of animals into primary simple components and puts them back into soil. It is this material that help the plants to grow. Thus we can see that there is a cyclic movement of materials from primary producers to highest level predators, then back to the soil.

Trophic levels

The energy is passed from the producer to the consumers. But, there are three different consumers in any food chain. How can we distinguish different consumers?

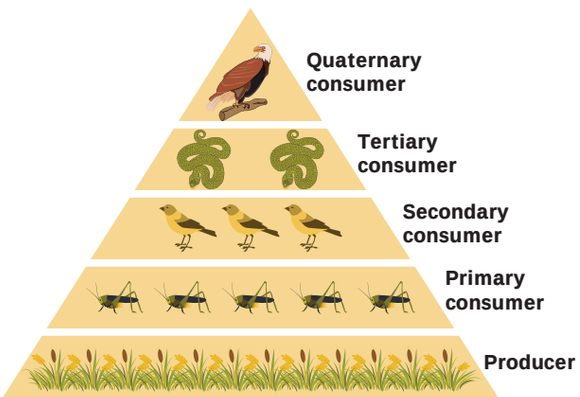
Animals that eat plants are **primary consumers.**

Animals that eat primary consumers are called **secondary consumers.**

Animals that eat the secondary consumers (mostly predators) are the **tertiary consumers.**

There may even be large predators that eat tertiary consumers. They are called as **quaternary consumers.**

Each of these levels in the food chain is called a **trophic level.**



Organism uses up to 90% of its food energy for its life processes. Only about